

◆ A • THE WORLD

A form with one box on it, and two
people who cannot both be
measured by it
somebody that are not on their form

0A • Find it — fourteen things

Find these in the picture. Write the number.

☐ a table ☐ a chair ☐ a form ☐ a pen ☐ a notice ☐ a board ☐ a cup ☐ a bag ☐ a window ☐ a clock ☐ a door ☐ a box ☐ a light ☐ a coat

Three of these words are not in the picture. Which three?

an adventure · a prize · a language

0B • Guess it

Look at the two people filling in the form. **Which one has stopped writing?** Say one thing. You can use these words:

year · form · write · number · experience

0C • Say it

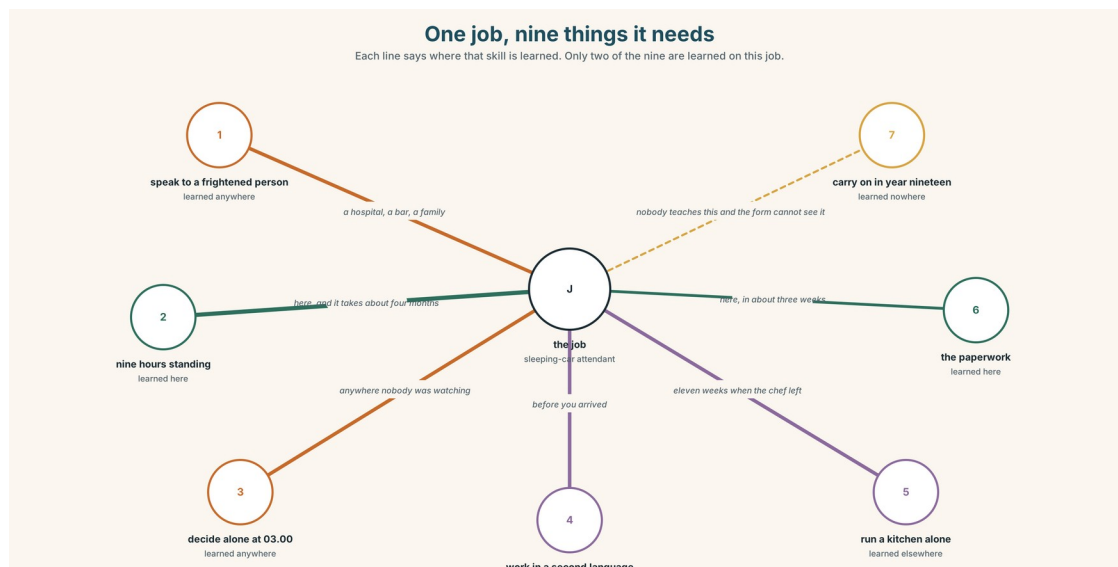
Record. Thirty seconds. Do not prepare.

Name three things you have done that are not on any form you have ever filled in.

You will listen to this again on the last page.

Part 1 • Vocabulary Lab 1 ◆ B • THE SYSTEM

1A • Meet — what a form asks and what it misses



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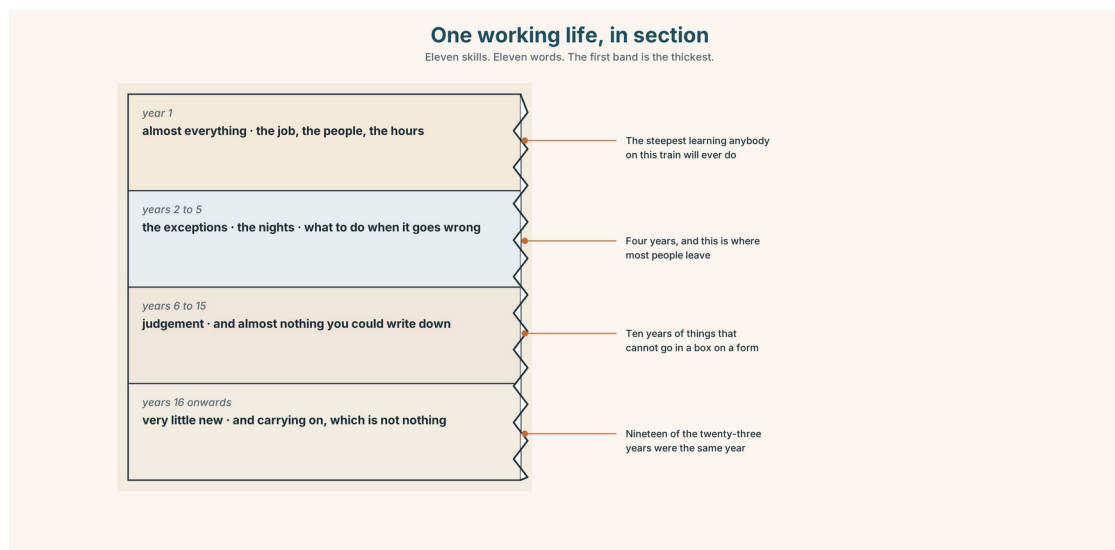
One job, nine things it needs — Each line says where that skill is learned. Only two of the nine are learned on this job.

experience	Measured in years, which measures time and not skill.
skill	The thing the years were supposed to stand for.
moment	The unit experience is actually made of.
learn a skill	Something that can be dated. Experience cannot.
try something new	The one activity that produces experience fastest and is nowhere on the form.
carry on	What twenty-three years is made of, and it is not nothing.

1B • Meet — the words

experience • skill • moment • adventure • abroad • foreign • language • swim • drive • cook • fly • climb • sing • ride • win • lose

Write each word under the right picture.



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One working life, in section — Eleven skills. Eleven words. The first band is the thickest.

1C • Sort — the thing, or the doing of it?

Put each word in the right box. **Two of them can go in both. Which two, and why?**

skill • swim • experience • drive • adventure • climb • language • win • moment • cook

A THING YOU HAVE

A THING YOU DO

BOTH

1D • What people put on forms

learn a skill	Has a start and an end. You can name the week.
pass a test	Has a date, a number and a certificate.
try something new	Has none of those, and it is the best predictor of the other three.
win a prize	Goes on a form. Means almost nothing about a job.
take up	Begin something and keep doing it.
carry on	Keep doing something after the reason has gone.

Now say them. Three of these six produce a piece of paper and three do not. **Which three, and which of the other three would you most want to know about somebody?**

1E • Stretch — the phrases you will need today

learn a skill · pass a test · try something new · take up · carry on

Match each phrase to the moment you need it.

1. You begin something in January and you are still doing it in June. → _____
2. There is a certificate on the wall with a date on it. → _____
3. It is week three and you are bad at it and you do not stop. → _____
4. You have never done it before and you do it anyway. → _____
5. Six weeks, a teacher and a thing you can now do. → _____

1F • The hard one

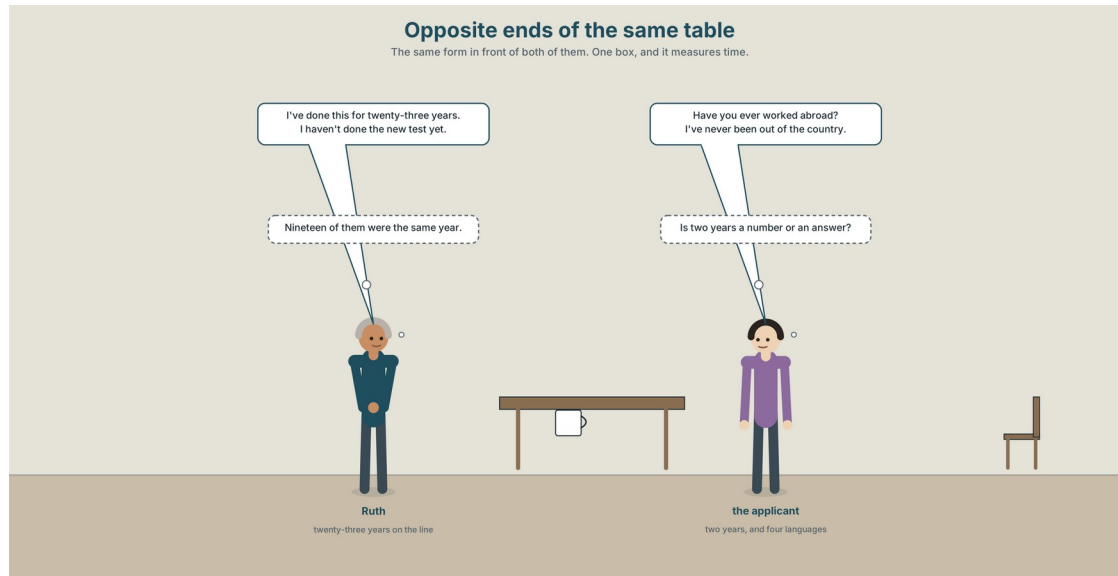
f Not yet.

Practise it three times. **Two words, and they are the difference between *no* and *not so far*.**

1G • Own it

Write down three things you have done that most people in this room have not. Do not write your name. The class guesses whose they are.

Part 2 • Listening ◆ A • THE WORLD



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Opposite ends of the same table — The same form in front of both of them. One box, and it measures time.

2A • The crew room 📻 Track 8.1

Before you listen. Both of them are applying for the same promotion. **Guess: which box is the biggest on the form?**

Listen once. One question. How many years has Ruth been on the line?

Listen again. Complete the table.

	Ruth	the applicant
years		
lived abroad		
worked nights		

Listen again. True or false?

- The applicant has worked abroad. ☐ T ☐ F
- Ruth has never worked nights. ☐ T ☐ F
- The applicant has already passed the test. ☐ T ☐ F
- Ruth has done this job for twenty-three years. ☐ T ☐ F

Noticing. Four sentences from the recording.

- Have you ever worked abroad?*
- I've never been out of the country.*
- I haven't done the test yet.*
- She's done this for twenty-three years.*

None of these four says when. Why would you choose a tense that leaves the date out?

2B • Decoding clinic 🎧 Track 8.2

Twenty seconds of the applicant at speed. Three jobs.

- 1. Count how many times you hear *have*, *has* or *'ve*.
- 2. In *I've* and *she's*, how long is the *have* or *has* sound?
- 3. He says *been* and *gone*. Is the person back, in each one?

Transcripts, page 155.

Part 3 • Grammar Lab 1 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

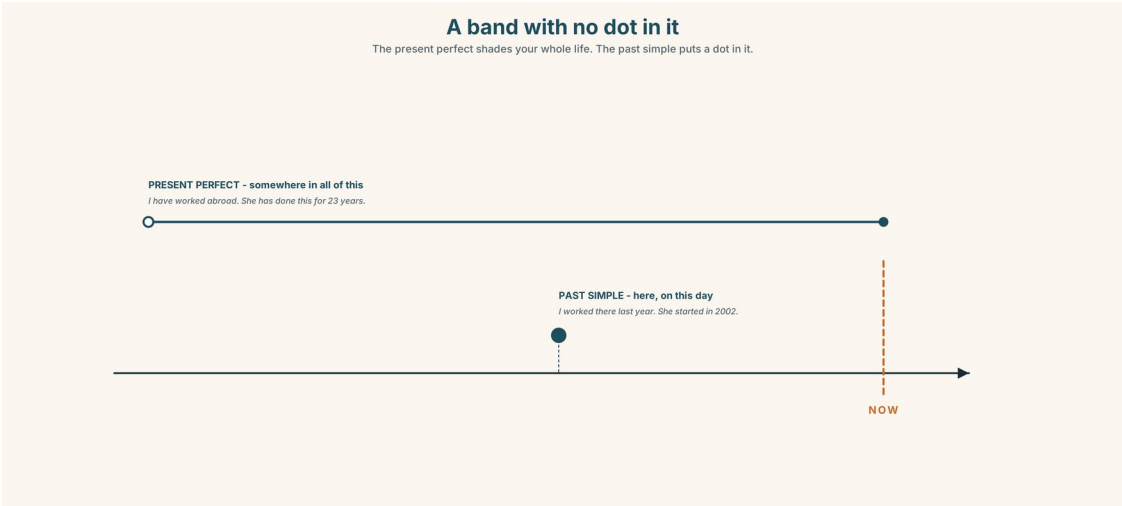
Saying it happened without saying when

3A • Notice

Look at the four sentences in Part 2 again.

- 1. What two parts make this form of the verb?
- 2. Does any of the four say when it happened?
- 3. Where does *ever* go? Where does *never* go?
- 4. What is the difference between *I haven't done it* and *I didn't do it*?

3B • See



6in}

A band with no dot in it — The present perfect shades your whole life. The past simple puts a dot in it.

3C • Know

experience	have / has + past participle	<i>I have worked abroad. She has done this for 23 years.</i>
the question	Have you ever...?	<i>Have you ever worked nights?</i>

never	one negative, already	<i>I have never been out of the country.</i>
not yet	it has not happened so far	<i>I haven't done the test yet.</i>

No date, ever. The moment you add a date — *last year, in 2019, when I was twenty* — you must change to the past simple. The present perfect and a date cannot stand in the same sentence.



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Three kinds of participle, and one pair that matters — Been and gone are the same journey and they end in different places.

same as the past	<i>worked · lived · made · bought · had</i>
different	<i>do → did → done · see → saw → seen · go → went → gone</i>
been or gone	<i>She's been to Jasper — she is back · She's gone to Jasper — she is not</i>
already / yet	<i>already in positives, yet in negatives and questions</i>

Why it matters. Every interview, every introduction and every conversation with somebody you have just met runs on this tense, and it is the first tense in this book that has no equivalent in most languages.

3D • Use — controlled

Complete with the present perfect, **ever**, **never**, **already** or **yet**.

(1) _____ you _____ (work) abroad? — No, I (2) _____ (be) out of the country. I (3) _____ (not do) the test _____. She (4) _____ (do) this job for twenty-three years. He (5) _____ (pass) the test — last month, in fact.

3E • Use — guided

Turn each one into a question with *Have you ever...?*, then answer it two ways.

1. work nights
2. drive a truck
3. live abroad

4. sing in front of people
5. lose something important

3F • Use — open

In pairs. Find **five things your partner has done and you have not.** Only *Have you ever...*? questions. **You may not ask when.**

3G • Check — six items, mark your own

1. _____ you ever _____ (work) abroad?
2. I've _____ been out of the country.
3. I _____ (not do) the test yet.
4. She _____ (do) this for twenty-three years.
5. × *I have worked there last year.* → correct it.
6. × *Have you ever went to Jasper?* → correct it.

A date on a tense that refuses dates

✗ I have worked there last year.

The present perfect says: somewhere in my life, and I am not telling you when. Adding a date contradicts the tense you have just chosen. English hears this as two different sentences stuck together, and it is one of the few errors that makes a listener stop and reparse.

✓ I worked there last year.

The moment a date appears, use the past simple. The rule is mechanical and it never fails: no date, present perfect; any date at all, past simple. This is also why a conversation always starts in one and moves into the other.

What the writer thought:
 The present perfect has have in it, which looks present, and a past participle, which looks past - so it feels like a tense that can do both. It cannot. What it does is leave the time out on purpose, and a date puts it back in.

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A date on a tense that refuses dates — A date on a tense that refuses dates

0–3 → Workbook pp. 32–35. **4–5** → Part 6. **6** → page 178.

Part 4 • Speaking ◆ C • THE PERFORMANCE

4A • Fluency starter — find somebody who

Everybody writes one *Have you ever...*? question. **Ask until you find somebody who says yes.** **You may not ask the same person twice.**

4B • The functional core — talking about experience

Two interviews for one job
The left asks about years. The right asks what the person has done.

how long?

"Two years." — 4 minutes · one number

have you ever?

4 languages · 11 weeks alone · twice at 02.00 — 9 minutes

Find the six. One of the two found out that the candidate had run a kitchen alone for eleven weeks. Which, and what did it cost in minutes?

6 differences — find them all

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Two interviews for one job — The left asks about years. The right asks what the person has done.

Language Bank

asking	<i>Have you ever...? · How long have you...?</i>
saying yes	<i>Yes, once. · Yes, a few times. · Only once.</i>
saying no	<i>No, never. · Not yet. · I've never...</i>
following up	<i>What happened? · When was that? — and now you are in the past simple</i>

Information gap. Learner A has what the application form asks. Learner B has what the job actually requires. **Find the three requirements the form cannot see.**

4C • The performance — three things not on the form

Interview a classmate and find **three things they have done that no form would ask about. Three minutes.** You must:

ask six *Have you ever...?* questions · follow one of them into the past simple · find one thing nobody else in the room has done

Report in three sentences. **Record it.**

4D • Observer

One person listens for **one thing**: did anybody put a date in a present perfect sentence?

4E • Two criteria

☐ Were all my experience questions in the present perfect? ☐ Did I switch to the past simple the moment I asked *when*?

Part 5 • Reading ♦ A • THE WORLD

5A • Predict

The title is "**Years of experience: ____**" **Why do you think there is a blank in the title?**

5B • Read — sixty seconds

Years of experience: ____

The application form has one box about experience. It says: YEARS OF EXPERIENCE. There is a line after it.

Ruth has written 23. The other applicant has written 2 and then stopped writing.

He has worked two years on this line. He has also run a kitchen alone for eleven weeks when the chef left without notice, and he has worked in four languages, and he has twice talked somebody out of getting off a train in the middle of a prairie at two in the morning.

None of that is on the form. There is nowhere to put it. The form does not ask whether you have ever done anything; it asks how long you have been near it.

Ruth has twenty-three years and she has also done all three of those things, more than once. The form cannot tell the difference between them either.

5C • Answer

1. What does the box on the form say?
2. What has Ruth written?
3. What did the other applicant do when the chef left?
4. How many languages has he worked in?
5. **Why did he stop writing?**
6. **The last line says the form cannot tell the difference between them either. What is the form actually measuring?**

5D • Vocabulary in context

Guess from the text. Then check.

without notice · talked somebody out of · nowhere to put it · how long you have been near it · more than once

5E • The counter-text

The application form

Eleven boxes. Nine of them are about dates and documents.

PRAIRIE LINE - INTERNAL APPLICATION - FORM HR/14

BOX	ASKS FOR	SCORED
1-3	NAME, NUMBER, DEPOT	NO
4	DATE JOINED	YES
5	YEARS OF EXPERIENCE	YES
6	CURRENT GRADE	YES
7	SAFETY CERTIFICATE DATE	YES
8	FIRST AID CERTIFICATE	YES
9	DAYS ABSENT, 24 MONTHS	YES
10	LANGUAGES (TICK BOX)	YES
11	OTHER - 4 LINES	NO

Boxes about dates or documents 9 of 11

Boxes about what you can do 1 of 11

Size of the OTHER box 4 lines

UNDER THE OTHER BOX, IN 7 POINT:

"Information provided here will be read but does not form part of the score." The only box on the form that could hold eleven weeks of running a kitchen alone, and it has been declared worthless in advance.

Box 5. One line, and it asks for a number of years

Days absent is scored. Nobody has explained what it measures

Languages is a tick box, so four languages and one look the same

Nine boxes a computer can read. One a person would have to

Read but not scored - which means read by nobody

6in}

The application form — Eleven boxes. Nine of them are about dates and documents.

Read the form and answer.

1. How many boxes are there?
2. **How many are about dates or documents, and how many about what somebody can do?**
3. How big is the OTHER box?
4. **What does the line under the OTHER box say, and what does that do to the box above it?**

5F • Two texts

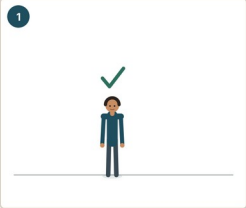
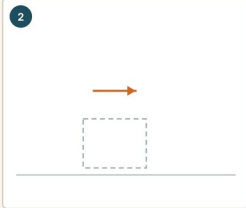
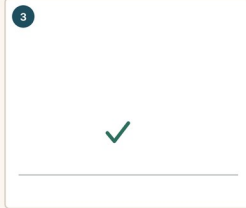
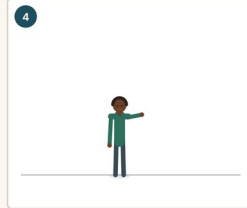
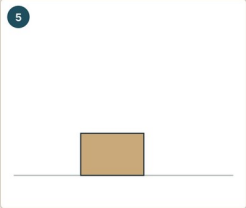
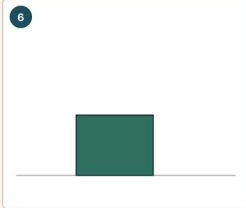
The reading says one applicant has run a kitchen alone for eleven weeks. The form has four unscored lines for anything that is not a date.

Where would that go? Say one sentence.

Part 6 • Vocabulary Lab 2 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Been, gone, done, seen

Six participles, six small scenes
The first two are the same journey. They end in different places.

1  BEEN - the journey is over, she is here	2  GONE - the journey is over, she is there	3  DONE - finished, and it stays finished	4  SEEN - you were there when it happened
5  HAD - It was yours, at some point	6  MADE - It did not exist and now it does		

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Six participles, six small scenes — The first two are the same journey. They end in different places.

6A • The ones that catch everybody

been / gone

been means you came back; *gone* means you are still there

already / yet

already in positives; *yet* at the end of negatives and questions

ever

only in questions: *Have you ever...?*
— never in a statement

never

already negative, so no *haven't* with it

6B • Say them

ever • never • always • already • yet • been • gone • done • seen

6C • Chunk

1. _____ you ever been abroad?
2. I've _____ been abroad.
3. I haven't done it _____.
4. I've _____ done it. (*and before you asked*)
5. _____ . (*two words — it has not happened so far*)
6. _____ . (*two words — it happened exactly one time*)

6D • Contrast Clinic

Six items. **been** or **gone**?

1. She's _____ to Jasper — she'll be back on Friday.
 2. She's _____ to Jasper — she came back last week.
 3. He's _____ out. He'll be back at six.
 4. I've _____ to Vancouver three times.
 5. They've _____ home. The room is empty.
 6. Have you ever _____ to Winnipeg?
-

Part 7 • Pronunciation & Fluency Lab ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

The have that is almost not there

The have that is almost not there		
Written in full above, said below. In two of these the word disappears completely.		
I have done it	→	I v d u n i t
have is one consonant		
he has gone	→	h e e z g o n
has becomes a z		
you have seen	→	y o o v s e e n
same as the first		
have you ever	→	a v y o o - e v v a
the h goes first		
has she been	→	u z s h e e - b i n
two words, one sound		

6in}

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The have that is almost not there — Written in full above, said below. In two of these the word disappears completely.

7A • Hear

I have → *I've*, one sound · **he has** → *he's* · **you have** → *you've* **have you** → *hav-yuh*, and the *h* almost goes · **has she** → *uz-shee* In a statement, *have* is never stressed. If it is, you are arguing.

7B • Say

Say each one three times. Then say this:

I've never been there, and he's already gone. — two perfects, four beats.

7C • Make it mean something

Say these two:

I've done it. — ordinary. *Have* has almost no sound at all. *I HAVE done it.* — you are contradicting somebody who said you had not.

The full form is an argument. Learners who always use the full form sound permanently defensive. Which one would you use to answer a friendly question?

7D • Fluency 20

Twenty seconds: **six things you have done in your life, no dates.** Three times, faster.

Part 8 • Writing C • THE PERFORMANCE

What you have done • 50–70 words

8A • Read the model

I have worked on this line for two years. [the number the form asks for, got out of the way]

I have also run a kitchen alone for eleven weeks, when the chef left without notice. [the thing the form does not ask about, with the reason it happened]

I have worked in four languages and I have twice talked somebody out of getting off a train at two in the morning. [two more, and the second one is specific]

I have never managed anybody. That is the only thing on this list I have not done. [the honest gap, volunteered]

Questions about the writer's choices:

1. The first line gives the number. **Why get it out of the way first?**
2. *at two in the morning.* **Why is the detail the whole sentence?**
3. The last line admits a gap nobody asked about. **What does that buy?**

8B • The anti-model

I have two years of experience on this line. I am hard-working and reliable. I have good communication skills. I work well in a team. I am looking for a new challenge.

Correct English, and it is on nine million applications. **Rewrite it with three things that have actually happened and one thing you have never done.**

8C • Plan

the number they asked for → the thing they did not ask about → two more, one of them specific → the honest gap

8D • Write — 50 to 70 words

8E • Peer review — two things only

☐ Is every sentence in the present perfect, with no dates? ☐ Is there one thing in it nobody else in this room could write?

8F • Publish

On the wall, with no names. **The class reads them and marks the one line in each that could not be on a form.**

Your English as experience, not as a level — Four layers. The bottom one predicts the other three.

9A • The list nobody keeps

Five firsts, four with no date — Every one of these is a present perfect sentence, and nobody wrote any of them down.

What they remember	four or five moments
What the moments are	firsts — and every one of them is a present perfect sentence
What is missing	a list, because nobody ever told anyone to keep one

9B • Your firsts

Write five sentences beginning *I have...* about English. **No dates.** First time you understood a film, were understood by a stranger, read a page without stopping, made somebody laugh, had an argument.

9C • Role play — the interview nobody gives

In pairs. Interview your partner about their English with ten *Have you ever...?* questions. **No question may be about a course, a level or a score.**

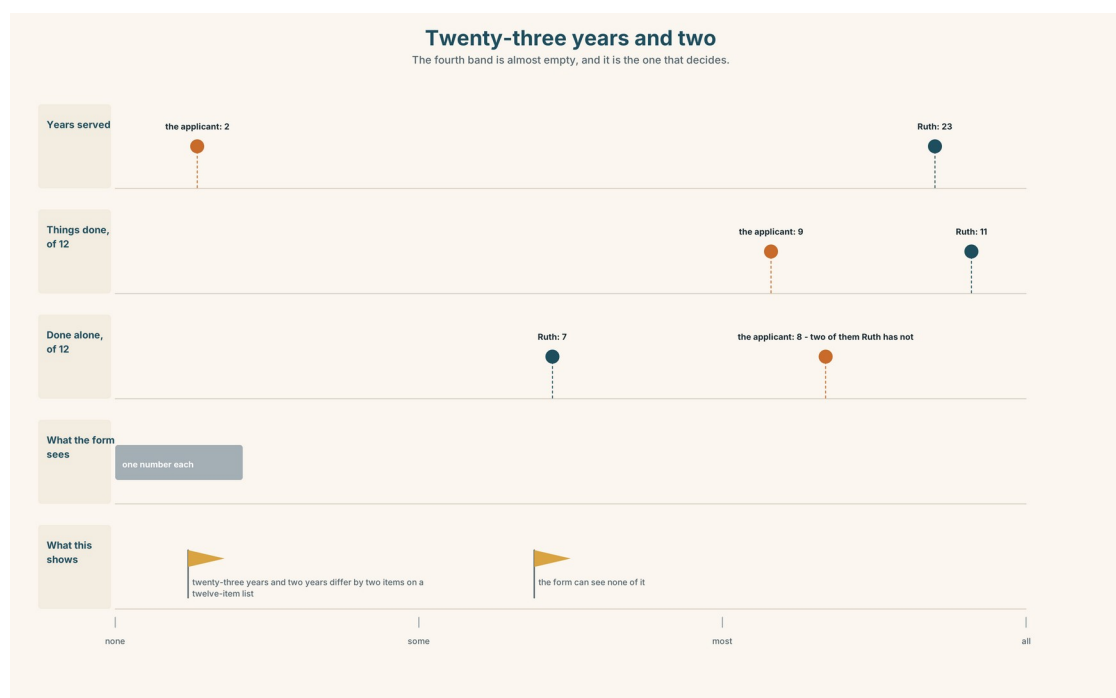
9D • The one you have not done yet

Look at your list of firsts. **Name the next one.** Write it as *I haven't ... yet*. That sentence is a plan with a date you have not set.

9E • Transfer — before next week

Keep a list of English firsts for seven days. However small. Bring it. Most people find three or four and are surprised by all of them.

Part 10 • Mediation & Interaction ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE



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Twenty-three years and two — The fourth band is almost empty, and it is the one that decides.

10A • Relay

Half the class has the form. Half has what the job actually needs. **Build the real requirement list by speaking.** Ten minutes.

10B • Simplify — for one person

Somebody is filling in a form with one experience box and they have done a great deal. **Advise them in four sentences.** Be practical, not encouraging.

10C • Online

Write **one message** to a classmate asking about three experiences. **Three sentences.** Three *Have you ever...?* questions, and no dates.

10D • Your language

Does your language have a tense for experience without a date? **Say *I have been to Canada* in your language.** Does it sound like the past, or like now?

Part 11 • The Decision ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

One box on a form

The company promotes about nine sleeping-car attendants a year. The form has one experience box and it asks for years.

Option one: keep it. Years are cheap to check and impossible to argue with.

Option two: replace it with a checklist of twelve things — *have you ever run a service alone, have you ever dealt with a medical event, have you ever worked in a language that is not your first.* Takes four minutes to fill in and two hours a year to score.

Option three: a day's trial on a real train. Expensive, accurate, and it cannot be done for more than about thirty people a year.

11A • The evidence

Two forms, side by side

The years box on the left, the twelve-item checklist on the right.

the years box

23 · 2 · everything else blank · 40 seconds

the twelve-item list

11 ticks · 9 ticks · 2 of them Ruth has never done · 4 minutes

Find the six. One of them is how long each form took to fill in, and it is the argument that will decide this.

6 differences — find them all

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6in}

Two forms, side by side — The years box on the left, the twelve-item checklist on the right.

 **Track 8.6.** Ruth, 20 seconds: "I've been here twenty-three years. Nineteen of them were the same year. I'd rather be asked what I've done than how long I've been standing here."

11B • Talk about it

In threes. Use the frame. Everybody says one.

I think the company should _____, because _____.

Words you can use: *experience · skill · moment · learn a skill · try something new · win · lose*

11C • Decide

Write **two sentences**. Choose, and say why.

I think the company should _____, because _____.

11D • Model decision

The checklist. Two hours a year is nothing and years of experience is not a measurement, it is a proxy for one. The trial is better and it does not scale, and the thing that does not scale is the thing that gets quietly dropped in a bad year.

11E • The Reveal

What happened. The company introduced the twelve-item checklist. In the first year the promotions went to almost the same nine people.

Then something nobody expected: the checklist was being read by the people filling it in. Four attendants asked to be put on night services specifically because there was a line on the form about them, and the company had never once been asked that before.

One question. You do not have to answer it out loud.

The checklist did not change who was promoted. What did it change?

Part 12 • Landing ◆ all three lines

12A • Recycle — twelve items

1. _____ you ever _____ (work) abroad?
2. I've _____ been out of the country.
3. I haven't done it _____ .
4. I've _____ done it. (*and before you asked*)
5. She's _____ to Jasper — she's still there.
6. She's _____ to Jasper — she's back.
7. _____ . (*two words — it has not happened so far*)
8. _____ . (*two words — exactly one time*)
9. I'd like to _____ running. (*two words — begin, and keep going*)
10. You have to _____ when it gets hard. (*two words*)
11. (*Unit 7*) You _____ touch it. (*forbidden*)
12. (*Unit 6*) It will _____ close. (*seventy per cent*)

12B • Consolidate — one task, everything in it

Write six sentences about what one person you know has done. All six in the present perfect, no dates, one with *never*, one with *yet*, and one that nobody else in this room could write.

12C • Can-do, with evidence

☐ I can talk about experience without saying when. **Evidence:** 4C, 8D ☐ I can ask *Have you ever...?* **Evidence:** 4A, 3F ☐ I can use *been, gone, already* and *yet*. **Evidence:** 6D ☐ I can say the weak forms of *have* and *has*. **Evidence:** 7C

12D • Replay 🟡

Record 0C again. **Listen to both.** What is different?

12E • Glossary — thirty-five words, as a map

THE NOUNS • experience • skill • moment • adventure • language **WHERE** • abroad • foreign
THE VERBS • swim • drive • cook • fly • climb • sing • ride • win • lose **WHAT GOES ON A FORM**
• learn a skill • pass a test • win a prize **WHAT DOES NOT** • try something new • take up • carry
on **THE GRAMMAR** • ever • never • always • already • yet • been • gone • done • seen **SAYING**
IT • Have you ever...? • I've never... • Not yet. • Only once.

12F • Next

Unit 9 • How does weather change a day?